

PREMIUM GUIDE

UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA

Complete Admission Guide for Indian Students

Programs, Fees, Scholarships, Placements & Campus Life

Los Angeles, California

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1. University of Southern California at a Glance

#116

QS RANKING

1880

FOUNDED

49,000

STUDENTS

2,800+

INDIAN STUDENTS

93%

PLACEMENT RATE

Attribute	Details
Full Name	University of Southern California
Location	Los Angeles, California, USA
Type	Private (Est. 1880)
Acceptance Rate	13%
Student-Faculty Ratio	9:1
Graduation Rate	92%
International Students	24%
Gender Ratio	50:50
Website	usc.edu
Motto	The Trojan Family — Network for Life

USC is a private research university in Los Angeles, California. Home to the largest international student population in the US, USC is renowned for engineering, business, and cinematic arts programs.

Notable Alumni

Neil Armstrong — First man on the moon

Shripriya Mahesh — VP Product at eBay

Marc Benioff — Founder of Salesforce

2. Why Choose University?

- Largest international student body in the US — very diverse
- Located in LA — entertainment, tech, and aerospace hub
- USC Viterbi School of Engineering is top 10 in the US
- Trojan alumni network of 450,000+ worldwide
- Beautiful campus with year-round perfect weather
- Strong in entertainment tech, game design, and VR

| Academic Environment

Trojan Family pride with serious academics. Viterbi (engineering) is top 10 in the US. The School of Cinematic Arts is Hollywood's talent pipeline. Professors have industry connections — your networking starts in class. The largest international student body in the US means diversity is real.

| Student Life

LA lifestyle at its finest. The campus is beautiful year-round. Beach trips to Santa Monica, hikes to Griffith Observatory, concerts at the Forum. The Trojan Family network is 450,000+ strong. House parties in the USC area are legendary. You're living the California dream.

3. Programs & Courses

Popular Programs for Indian Students

Program			Level	Duration	Tuition	Highlights
MS	in	Computer Science	PG	2 Years	\$32K-36K/yr	Top-ranked with specializations in AI, robotics, game development.
MS	in	Electrical Engineering	PG	2 Years	\$32K-36K/yr	VLSI, embedded systems, and communications focus.

4. Eligibility & Requirements

Admission Requirements

Requirement	Details
GPA	7.5+
GRE	310+
IELTS	6.5+
TOEFL	90+
Work Experience	Not required
LORs	3 LORs
SOP	Required
Resume	Required
Interview	Optional
Application Fee	\$90

5. Application Deadlines

Intake	Deadline	Decision Date
Fall (Aug)	Dec 15	Mar 31
Spring (Jan)	Aug 31	Oct 15

6. Tuition & Cost of Living

Expense Category	Cost
Tuition (MS)	\$32,000-36,000/yr
Accommodation	\$15,000-30,000/yr
Food	\$4,000-6,000/yr
Transport	\$2,000/yr
Health Insurance	\$3,000/yr
Personal	\$4,000-6,000/yr

7. Scholarships & Funding

Scholarship	Amount	Eligibility	Deadline
USC Merit Scholarship	\$10,000-25,000/yr	Strong academic + leadership record	Dec 15
Viterbi Graduate Fellowship	Full tuition	Top 5% applicants	Dec 15

8. Placements & Career Outcomes

93% PLACEMENT RATE	\$115,000 AVG SALARY	\$200,000 HIGHEST SALARY	1,000+ COMPANIES
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Post-Study Work Pathway

OPT → H-1B → Green Card | Work visa duration: 3 years (STEM OPT)

9. Campus Life for Indians

Aspect	Details
Indian Association	USC India Graduate Student Association
Accommodation	On-campus housing + LA apartments
Avg Rent	\$1,200-2,500/month
Indian Food	Artesia (Little India, 30 min) — 50+ Indian restaurants
Weather	Perfect year-round (15-28°C). Sunny almost every day.
Transport	Free campus shuttle + LA Metro
Healthcare	USC Engemann Student Health Center
Safety	Private campus security. Safe within campus boundaries.

Nightlife & Social Scene

Downtown LA (DTLA) for rooftop bars and clubs. Koreatown for KBBQ and karaoke. Hollywood for concerts and events. The Greek Row near campus for student parties. Santa Monica for beachside bars.

Student Clubs & Societies

- **USC India Graduate Student Association** — Cultural
- **Trojan Bhangra** — Dance
- **USC Hindu Student Council** — Cultural
- **Viterbi Innovation Partners** — Tech
- **USC Entrepreneurs** — Entrepreneurship
- **Trojan Gaming Club** — Gaming
- **USC Photography Society** — Creative
- **Trojan Esports** — Gaming

11. What Students Say

"Every day feels like a movie scene. Palm trees, sunshine, and the Hollywood sign in the distance. I forget I'm studying."

— **Vivek**, MS CS '24

"My professor introduced me to a VP at Netflix. That's the Trojan network. It's not a myth."

— **Neha**, MS EE '25

"Living 20 minutes from the beach while doing cutting-edge VR research. California is unbeatable."

— **Rohan**, MS CS '23

Your University Journey Starts Here

Get expert guidance on your University of Southern California application — SOP review, LOR templates, visa prep, and more.

www.kohortconnect.com

